My Brother’s Keeper

Am I my brother’s keeper? Yes. Don’t grow weary in doing good, admonish the disobedient brother as family — and rest in the Lord of peace and the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ.

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Where this study fits

2 Thessalonians · seven studies · this study highlighted

01 1:1–2
Introduction and Background

02 1:3–12
Paul's Admiration for the Thessalonians

03 2:1–5
Confusion Concerning the Coming

04 2:6–12
The Removal of the Restrainer

05 2:13–17
The Day of the Lord and Believers

06 3:1–12
Serving While Waiting

07 3:13–18
My Brother's Keeper

Grace and peace frame the letter (1:2; 3:16–18): persecution in chapter 1, prophecy in chapter 2, correction in chapter 3.

Five closing words

2 Thessalonians 3:13–18 · Outline I–V

A **Confirmation · v.13**

“Do not grow weary in doing good”

B **Admonition · vv.14–15**

Note him, withdraw — but admonish him as a brother

C **Benediction · v.16**

“The Lord of peace Himself give you peace always”

D **Validation · v.17**

“With my own hand, which is a sign in every epistle”

E **Salutation · v.18**

“The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you all”

✓ **Yes**

I am my brother’s keeper — and my sister’s

Help, don’t enable

Introduction and I · Confirmation — 3:13

Enabling

- “Helping” someone keep doing wrong
- Like money that buys drugs
- Some fed the idle and their meddling

vs

Helping
καλοποιέω doing good · G2569

- Work and care for your family
- Do the work of the church
- Don’t grow weary (ἐκκακέω)

Even when you grow tired in doing good, don’t grow tired of doing good. Keep on keeping on.

Withdraw — but as family

2 Thessalonians 3:14–15 · II — Admonition

A

Note him

Don’t disobey the epistle — it is God’s Word

σημειόω · v.14a

B

Withdraw

“Can two walk together unless they are agreed?”

συναναμίγνυμι · Amos 3:3

C

That he be ashamed

Constructive, never destructive

ἐντρέπω · v.14c

D

Admonish as a brother

Not an enemy — family

νουθετέω · v.15

He is still a “brother” (3:6, 15). Withdrawal addresses his fellowship, not his eternal life — relationship is settled at faith; fellowship is restored by confession (1 John 1:9).

“Brother Horatio …”

2 Thessalonians 3:15b · II.B.2 — Counsel him as family

Before you go

- The Lord lays it on your heart
- You’re convinced it’s your assignment
- You have prayed hard
- He gives you a clear path

When you go

1. **“Brother Horatio, we’re brothers.”**
   Children of God — start with the relationship
2. **“I’m concerned about you …”**
   Then name the area — name the offense
3. **“May I show you in the Word?”**
   Ask permission; if no, take the next step (Matt 18)

“Make sure I don’t get to be an enemy by the way I handle the job the Lord gave me.”

Peace three ways

2 Thessalonians 3:16 · III — Benediction

Peace with God

- Justified by faith
- Settled and guaranteed
- Rom 5:1

The peace of God

- Be anxious for nothing — pray
- Peter asleep in prison (Acts 12)
- Phil 4:6–7

The God of peace

- “I will never leave you” — Heb 13:5
- With you always — Matt 28:20
- “With you all”

εἰρήνη Peace with God is guaranteed. The peace of God is something we ask for — we let our requests be known to Him, and leave it there.

Signed by hand — sealed with grace

2 Thessalonians 3:17–18 · IV–V — Validation and salutation

Validation · v.17
ἀσπασμός · σημεῖον salutation · sign

- Paul signs with his own hand
- “A sign in every epistle”
- The test against the forged letter (2:2)

vs

Salutation · v.18
χάρις grace · G5485

- Saving grace — Eph 2:8–9
- Sharing grace — 2 Cor 8:7
- Serving grace — Heb 12:28

Am I my brother’s keeper? Yes — and he is my brother, not my enemy. The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you all.

Discuss and apply

2 Thessalonians 3:13–18 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. What is the difference between helping a brother and enabling him, and how does this connect to the idle Thessalonians?

2. What is the purpose of church discipline in 3:14–15?

Apply

Help, Don’t Enable
Ask the Lord whether any of your help has become enabling, and what real help would look like.

Never, Ever Alone
Each evening, write down one worry, pray it through Philippians 4:6–7, and leave it there.

In one line: Yes, I am my brother’s keeper — keep doing good, restore him as family, and rest in the Lord of peace and His grace.